

Trophy

Alex Baker Wins It in Round One

Twelve points clear after a 46 on the Tour course, the three-time Spoon holder spent the next three rounds handing it back in instalments — and never quite ran out.

Alex Baker won the TEG 18 Trophy with 169 Stableford points, eight clear of John Patterson. It is the second-highest total of his own career. He led from the fifth hole of the first round and never handed it back. He also posted the worst round in the history of the course. Nobody has yet suggested the two are incompatible.

The platform was laid in the first round on the PGA Catalunya Tour course. He took 17 points from holes 8 to 12: two pars, three bogeys, nothing worse. Then 13 more across 14 to 16, the birdie at the par-five 15th the pick of them. A double bogey at the 17th ended the run of par or better. His 98 was his best score of the tournament on the Tour course, though some way off the 92 he posted there in TEG 11.

Round two ran the other way, and ran a considerable distance. Alex Baker signed for 106 gross. It is the highest round ever recorded on the Tour course, beating the previous worst of 105 set across 22 prior visits. A quintuple-bogey eight at the par-three 16th was his worst ever return on that par. The eleven at the par-five 18th performed the same service for par fives. He ended the day still leading the Trophy, with Jon Baker ahead in the TEG 18 Green Jacket.

He held the lead after round three, built on 21 points from holes 11 to 16 on the Stadium course. He held it again after round four, despite a ten at the 14th and an eight at the 17th. The ten arrived with the tournament effectively in his pocket. He appeared entirely untroubled by it. Gregg Williams led the Jacket over the closing two rounds.

AT A GLANCE
Trophy Winner Alex Baker (2nd Trophy) Runner-up: John Patterson
Green Jacket Gregg Williams (3rd Jacket) Runner-up: David Mullin
Wooden Spoon Jon Baker (2nd Spoon) Next above: David Mullin

FINAL · Trophy
AB 169 JP 161 GW 160 DM 149 JB 126
FINAL · Green Jacket
GW +66 DM +80 JB +92 JP +95 AB +124

Green Jacket | Gregg Williams

Nine at the Seventh, Jacket by Fourteen

Gregg Williams turned up as the reigning Wooden Spoon holder and left with the gross title prised off David Mullin, who has won it nine times.

Gregg Williams won the TEG 18 Green Jacket at +66 gross, 14 clear of David Mullin. He did it from an opening round that had appeared to rule him out entirely. On the Tour Course at PGA Catalunya he ran up a nine at the par-five 7th and an eight at the par-four 17th, both quadruple bogeys. After a par at the 1st, he did not make a hole better than bogey until a birdie at the 15th finally broke the run. The round came in at 31 points.

The second round was 42. An eleven-point swing, delivered without ceremony. Williams took nine points from holes 3 to 5, then played 13 to 16 in level par for 13 points. Jon Baker had led the gross competition since the 5th hole of round one. He lost it at the 7th in round two, after 20 holes in front. Williams drew level at the 13th and went outright ahead at the 2nd hole of round three, on the Stadium Course.

From there he mostly held on. A bogey at the 1st opened round three, followed by four pars and then a double bogey at the 6th. He birdied the 5th in the final round and picked up nine points across holes 8 to 10. His 84 in round four was his best score on the Stadium Course, one better than the 85 he shot there in round three. It equalled the Stadium course record, set by David Mullin with 84 in round three. His +66 is the lowest gross total of his TEG career. The man who began with two quadruple bogeys ended with the Jacket.

John Patterson

Twenty-Two Shots Gone by the Tenth

John Patterson outscored the champion over two of the four rounds and still lost by eight, all of it conceded on one stretch of the Tour course on the opening day.

John Patterson's TEG 18 Trophy was settled before the first round was half done. He stood on the third at PGA Catalunya's Tour Course and made an 8, a quadruple bogey. He then declined to steady himself for a further seven holes. From the 3rd to the 10th he bled 22 shots: triple bogeys at the 4th, 7th, 8th and 9th, doubles at the 5th, 6th and 10th. Across the 3rd to the 9th he did not make a single net par. The board registered the damage at once. The triple at the 4th dropped him to the bottom of the TEG 18 Wooden Spoon race.

What followed made the loss harder to explain away. Patterson took 13 points from the 13th to the 16th and finished the round 14 points better on the back nine than the front, for 34 points in all. In round two he took 16 points in five holes from the 11th to the 15th. His 94 there was his best gross score on the Tour Course, beating the 96 he posted in TEG 12. Round three brought a 93 on the Stadium Course, also a personal best there and four strokes better than his last visit. In round four he collected nine points across the 4th, 5th and 6th. A triple and a double at the 14th and 15th threatened a reprise. He stopped the slide with a birdie at the 17th. Arguably he was the better player: over the last three rounds he outscored Alex Baker by four points, and across all four he was 29 shots better on gross. After eight holes he was already out of it.

Wooden Spoon | Jon Baker

The Defending Champion Finishes Last

Jon Baker led the gross for 20 holes and collected the TEG 18 Wooden Spoon by 23 points, which in a field of five takes some doing.

Jon Baker arrived in Catalonia as the defending Trophy champion. He left with the TEG 18 Wooden Spoon, his 126 Stableford points the lowest in the field.

For a while it looked like a different tournament. Jon Baker took the lead in the TEG 18 Green Jacket, the gross competition, at the fifth hole of the opening round on the Tour Course and held it for 20 holes, into the second round. It ended at the par-five seventh on Sunday. Gregg Williams made a six there, Jon Baker an eight, and the lead changed hands. He answered late and answered well. A birdie at the 14th, then pars at the 15th, 16th, 17th and 18th. Sixteen points in five holes without dropping a gross shot. His 87 on the Tour Course was one stroke better than his previous visit there. By the close of round two, with Alex Baker leading the TEG 18 Trophy, Jon Baker was back in front in the Jacket.

Then came the Stadium Course. At the fourth in round three he ran up a nine, a quintuple bogey worth nothing at all. His best gross round on the Stadium was 97, eight strokes more than his last visit to the course. The Jacket lead did not come back. Neither did the Trophy defence. He finished 23 points adrift of every other man in the field, which takes a certain application.

Blow-up Holes

Eleven, Eleven and a Ten

An inventory of the holes where PGA Catalunya stopped being a golf course and became an administrative problem — two of the worst of them belonging to the winner.

TEG 18 produced three holes of ten or more strokes. The PGA Catalunya Tour course accounted for two of them on consecutive days.

David Mullin opened the tournament with an 11 at the par-five 15th in round one, a sextuple bogey and the worst hole against par of his TEG career. The same round brought a nine from Gregg Williams at the seventh and an eight at the 17th. John Patterson contributed an eight at the third, then added another at the 4th on Sunday.

Round two belonged to Alex Baker, in the sense that nobody else was competing for it. He took eight at the par-three 16th, five over par. He then closed with an 11 at the last, a sextuple bogey and the heaviest single hole of his TEG record. The round totalled 106 gross, a new worst score ever recorded on the Tour course, beating the previous mark of 105 set across 22 prior visits. For scale, Alex Baker's best gross on the course before this trip was 92.

The Stadium course was kinder without being clean. Jon Baker ran up a nine at the fourth in round three. In the final round Alex Baker added a ten at the 14th and an eight at the 17th. Eleven holes in all returned their players nothing whatsoever.

David Mullin

An Eleven, Then a Record 84

David Mullin took eleven shots at the 15th on the opening day and, two rounds later, went round the Stadium in fewer than anyone has managed in 27 previous TEG visits.

David Mullin's TEG 18 ran from one end of the scale to the other. The bad end came first. On the Tour Course in Round 1 he ran up an 11 at the par-five 15th. A sextuple bogey, no Stableford points, and the worst score relative to par of his career. It also moved him in the one table nobody wishes to move in: from second to the bottom of the TEG 18 Wooden Spoon race.

Round 3 on the Stadium Course produced the opposite. Mullin went round in 84 gross, a new course record, beating the previous mark of 89 set across 27 prior visits. It was comfortably his own best there too. Seven shots better than his previous personal best of 91 on the course, and eight fewer than his last visit.

Round 4, back on the Stadium, gave much of it away over the closing stretch. From the 14th he went four holes without a net par. Double bogey at the 14th. Triple at the par-five 15th. Doubles at the 16th and 17th. Nine shots against par in four holes, and three Stableford points from a possible eight. The record stood. The round it was set in bore no obvious family resemblance to the one that followed.

Records & Personal Bests

Notable achievements: TEG 18

Course Records

- Alex Baker's 106 at PGA Catalunya - Tour (R2) — a new course-worst, beyond 105; 27 earlier rounds there
- David Mullin's 84 at PGA Catalunya - Stadium (R3) — a new course record, beating 89; 27 earlier rounds there
- Gregg Williams's 84 at PGA Catalunya - Stadium (R4) — equals the course record, set by David Mullin in R3; 32 earlier rounds there

Rare Feats

- David Mullin runs up an 11 (+6) at the 15th (R1) — his career-worst on a par-5
- Alex Baker runs up an 11 (+6) at the 18th (R2) — his career-worst on a par-5
- Alex Baker runs up an 8 (+5) at the 16th (R2) — his career-worst on a par-3